

CSEC Spanish

Paper 02

Section IV – Reading Comprehension

Read the following selection carefully. Do NOT translate, but answer the questions in ENGLISH. Be sure to write the number of the question which you are answering.

Marisa's Wig

Marisa era una mujer simpática, alegre y tenía un cuerpo que todo el mundo admiraba. Un día ella fue a la playa con un compañero de trabajo que le gustaba mucho. Era su primera cita y realmente quería darle una impresión muy positiva.

Aunque no tenía ninguna intención de nadar, se puso un vestido de baño muy colorido. Al llegar a la playa, ella y su compañero se sentaron en la arena. Charlaron y bebieron jugo por un rato pero las aguas estaban tan atractivas que la pareja decidió nadar. Marisa fue la primera en entrar al mar. Apenas Marisa se tiró al agua, se vio algo negro que flotaba en la superficie del mar. El compañero muy sorprendido, le gritó: - ¡Marisa, mira allí! ¡tu cabello está flotando!

La pobre Marisa muy avergonzada, salió corriendo del mar. ¡Qué vergüenza! Había olvidado quitarse la peluca, y este hombre a quien estaba tratando de impresionar, ahora se había enterado de su secreto.

El compañero, al verla avergonzada le dijo:-No te preocupes, ¡tengo secador en casa!

Answer, In ENGLISH, the following questions based on the selection you have just read. Use a complete sentence for EACH response.

1. Describe Marisa's personality. (2 marks)
2. What did people admire about her? (1 mark)
3. With whom did she go out? (2 marks)
4. Describe Marisa's outfit. (2 marks)
5. Mention THREE things that Marisa and her companion did on the beach. (3 marks)
6. Why did they decide to go for a swim? (1 mark)
7. What happened when Marisa dived into the water? (2 marks)
8. What was her companion's immediate reaction? (2 marks)

9. How did Marisa react to her companion's comment? (2 marks)
10. Explain why she reacted in that way. (3 marks)

Total 20 marks

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1. Marisa is a nice and cheerful woman.
2. People admired her body.
3. She went out with someone who she worked
or work companion
with, who she really liked.
4. Marisa had on a very colourful bathing suit.
5. Three things that Marisa and her companion
sat on the sand, talked or chatted and drank juice.
6. They decided to go for a swim because the water
looked very nice and inviting.
7. When Marisa dived into the water Marisa's wig
came off and floated to the surface of the water.
~~floats on the surface of the water and she was~~
~~surprised.~~
8. Her companion's immediate reaction was ^{that he was surprised} and he yelled
to her that her hair was floating.
9. Marisa was very embarrassed and went out of
the sea running.
10. She had reacted that way because she had forgotten
to take it off and this was the man she was really

write on both sides of the paper and start each answer on a new page.

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trying to impress and now her secret was out.

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Example of an excellent answer

In assessing this question, marks were awarded for comprehension. Errors made in English were not heavily penalized except where the language was so severely distorted that it affected communication.

The candidate respected the rubric and answered the questions in English as required. The responses provided indicated that the candidate had fully understood the passage. There were serious pitfalls deserving of a tremendous loss of marks.

Question 1: The candidate selected two appropriate adjectives from the passage to describe personality. Sufficient information was provided and therefore full marks were awarded.

Question 2: An appropriate response was given based on the information in the passage.

Question 3: The candidate extracted the details necessary to provide a fully appropriate response.

Question 4: Two distinct pieces of information were required: mention of the outfit and its description. The candidate supplied both elements and was awarded marks accordingly.

Question 5: The candidate clearly demonstrated knowledge of the vocabulary that was expected to be recognized in order to respond correctly. The candidate noted the three points which answered the question.

Question 6: The candidate interpreted the information correctly and provided an acceptable response.

Question 7: All the elements required were outlined in the response. The candidate followed the thread of the story by mentioning 'Marisa's wig', inferred correctly.

Question 8: Two specific elements were adequate to respond fully. The candidate included all the items of information in the answer.

Question 9: The candidate responded appropriately, providing all the necessary details.

Question 10: The candidate made some correct inference and was awarded marks accordingly.

Measures for Improvement

With regard to question 10, the response could have been improved with more specific information as obtained from the passage. For example, instead of "she had forgotten to take it off", the candidate could have made specific reference to the wig. (Model answer: Her companion whom she was trying to impress found out that she was wearing a wig.)